Position yourself as an engineer who has adapted to AI-assisted development

1. Main statement — Professional and confident

I want to be transparent about the coding exercise. I haven't spent much time preparing for traditional live coding interviews.

Over the last couple of years, my development workflow has shifted significantly toward AI-assisted engineering.

As a senior engineer, I spend more time understanding requirements, breaking down complex problems, designing systems, making architectural decisions, identifying edge cases, reviewing AI-generated code, and ensuring production reliability.

I still understand the code I deliver and take full responsibility for its correctness. However, I no longer spend most of my day writing implementations from scratch without tools.

I'm comfortable explaining my technical approach, discussing trade-offs, and walking through how I would solve a problem. But I recognize that I may be less practiced at writing code from memory under timed interview conditions.

That doesn't mean I've moved away from hands-on engineering. It means the tools and the way I build software have evolved.

2. If challenged — "A senior engineer should still be able to code without AI."

I agree. Coding fundamentals remain essential.

A senior engineer must be able to reason about code, debug issues, understand performance trade-offs, identify incorrect implementations, and take ownership of the final solution.

At the same time, I believe engineering effectiveness should be measured by more than the ability to write code from memory under time pressure.

What matters most is the ability to solve complex problems, make sound technical decisions, build reliable systems, and use modern tools effectively.

My day-to-day work is focused on delivering engineering outcomes, not optimizing for how quickly I can reproduce an algorithm from memory.

3. My recommendation

I'm not questioning the importance of coding fundamentals. I'm highlighting the difference between demonstrating engineering competence and demonstrating speed in a tool-free coding exercise.